

NEIGHBORHOOD GOLF CARTS

PHONE SCREEN

Technician hire

15–20 minutes · Ryan

Golf Cart Technician — Phone Interview Scorecard

Purpose: See if they can learn the job — hands-on electrical/mechanical skill, how they figure out problems, safety, and whether they take coaching. **Golf cart experience is a plus, not required.** Skip hours/commute — already covered on Indeed.

Candidate: _____ Date: _____ Interviewer: _____

Indeed / source: _____ Phone: _____ Call length: _____ min

Scoring scale: 1 = Unsatisfactory · 2 = Developing · 3 = Solid / trainable · 4 = Strong | **Advance if:** Safety ≥ 3, Diagnostic ≥ 3, and overall trainable.

1. ROLE FRAME · 2 min · no score — set expectations

Say: “This is a shop job in Covington — we fix golf carts and install lithium batteries here. No house calls. Weekdays, working with our techs and me. You don’t need golf cart experience — we’ll teach that. If this call goes well, next step is a half-day hands-on test at the shop.”

■ Covered shop-only / no mobile ■ Covered Mon–Fri bay work ■ Covered “we train golf carts” ■ Covered shop eval next step

2. WORK BACKGROUND · 4 min · Score A

Ask:

1. “Walk me through what you’ve been doing for work the last couple of years.”
2. “Have you worked on cars, boats, RVs, forklifts, lawn equipment, or anything with batteries and wiring?”
3. “Have you used a multimeter — the tool that checks voltage?”
4. “Have you done mechanical work too — brakes, bearings, steering, that kind of thing?”
5. “Were you usually in a shop with other people, or mostly working alone?”

A. Electrical / mechanical experience (High weight)

“3” looks like: Has real hands-on electrical or shop work; can name things they’ve fixed.

Notes: what they’ve worked on _____

Score

1 ■ 2 ■ 3 ■ 4 ■

Background notes

3. HOW THEY FIGURE OUT PROBLEMS · 6 min · Scores B–D · highest weight

B. Won’t move

Ask: “A battery-powered vehicle won’t move at all. You’ve never worked on that brand before. What would you check first, and what would you check next?”

B. Won’t move (Highest)

“3” looks like: Starts simple and safe: confirm the problem, look around, check battery power, then follow the power path. Not “just replace the big expensive part.”

Score

1 ■ 2 ■ 3 ■ 4 ■

C. Dies when working hard

Ask: “It runs for a little bit, then dies when it goes up a hill. How would you figure out what’s wrong?”

C. Dies when working hard (Highest)

“3” looks like: Checks battery power while it’s resting and while it’s working; checks dirty/loose connections; then looks at other parts. Not guessing and swapping parts.

Score

1 ■ 2 ■ 3 ■ 4 ■

D. Something new to them

Ask: “It’s your first day and you’ve never seen this kind of machine. How do you learn it without guessing?”

D. Something new to them (Highest)

“3” looks like: Looks up manuals, asks a lead tech, tests step by step, writes down what they find. Asks for help instead of winging it.

Score

1 ■ 2 ■ 3 ■ 4 ■

Problem-solving notes (listen for: test before replacing parts)

4. SAFETY · 3 min · Score E · GATE — must be ≥ 3

Why we ask (you): Cart batteries can spark, burn skin, or short out tools. We’re checking if they’re careful — not if they know fancy electrical words.

Ask:

1. "A customer's golf cart is in your bay and you need to work around the batteries. Walk me through how you stay safe before you start."
2. "Why do shops tell people to take off rings and metal watches for this work?"
3. "Have you ever had a close call with tools or electricity? What did you learn?"

Good answer sounds like: turn key off / make sure it's not powered · take off metal jewelry · don't lay wrenches across battery posts · look before you touch · ask if unsure.

Bad answer sounds like: "I'd just dive in" · jokes about getting shocked · "safety switches get in the way so I'd bypass them."

E. Careful around batteries (GATE)

"3" looks like: Takes batteries seriously — jewelry off, thinks before touching, won't skip safety steps.

■ **FAIL SAFETY** → do not invite to shop eval

Score

1 ■ 2 ■ 3 ■ 4 ■

Safety notes**5. WORKING WITH THE TEAM · 3 min · Scores F–G****Ask:**

1. "After you find the problem, how do you write it down so the office can call the customer with a price?"
2. "Tell me about a time you got a diagnosis wrong. What did you do?"
3. "Are you okay learning a new type of machine if we show you a clear process?"
4. "Do you prefer finishing regular repair jobs, or only the tricky ones?"

F. Explaining work clearly (Medium)

"3" looks like: Can explain what they found in plain words so the office can quote the job.

Score

1 ■ 2 ■ 3 ■ 4 ■

G. Learns well / good teammate (High)

"3" looks like: Owns mistakes, asks for help, follows a process; doesn't guess when stuck.

Score

1 ■ 2 ■ 3 ■ 4 ■

Fit notes**6. BONUS ONLY (optional) · Score H · does not gate the hire**

Ask (optional): "Have you ever worked on a golf cart, UTV, or a lithium battery system?"

H. Golf cart or lithium experience (Bonus)

"3" looks like: Any cart / UTV / lithium experience is a plus. None is fine — mark N/A.

Score

1 ■ 2 ■ 3 ■ 4 ■

7. TOTALS & DECISION

A Transferable	B No-go	C Load	D Learning	E Safety	F Docs	G Coach	H Bonus
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____ / N/A

Core average (A–G, exclude H): _____ / 4 **Diagnostic average** (B–D): _____ / 4 Safety (E) ≥ 3? ■ Yes ■ No

■ ADVANCE

Safety ≥ 3, problem-solving (B–D) avg ≥ 3, can learn the job → schedule shop eval

■ MAYBE

Good with tools, weaker on electrical; honest about gaps and eager → heavier hands-on day

■ PASS

Guesses and swaps parts, unsafe, or can't describe how they've fixed anything

Next step if ADVANCE: shop evaluation — written knowledge (120), hands-on skills (120), troubleshooting & diagnostics (60). Ref: Hiring quiz evaluation – Technician.

Final recommendation / scheduling notes